

1.1 Systems architecture

Learners should have studied the following:

- the purpose of the CPU
- Von Neumann architecture:
 - MAR (Memory Address Register)
 - MDR (Memory Data Register)
 - Program Counter
 - Accumulator
- common CPU components and their function:
 - ALU (Arithmetic Logic Unit)
 - CU (Control Unit)
 - Cache
- the function of the CPU as fetch and execute instructions stored in memory
- how common characteristics of CPUs affect their performance:
 - clock speed
 - cache size
 - number of cores
- embedded systems:
 - purpose of embedded systems
 - examples of embedded systems.